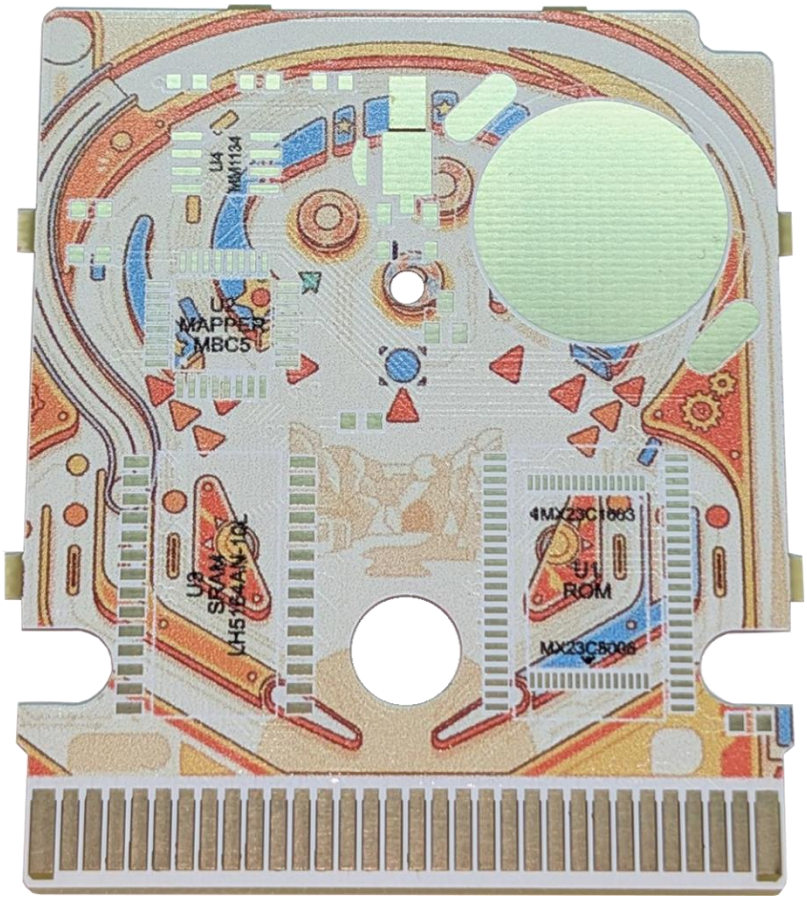
POKÉMON PINBALL
CUSTOM MOTHERBOARD



PRODUCT

HTTPS://SHOP.GILTESA.COM/PRODUCT/POKEMON-PINBALL-FOR-GAME-BOY-CUSTOM-MOTHERBOARD

PLEASE READ THROUGH THESE INSTRUCTIONS ENTIRELY BEFORE ATTEMPTING TO INSTALL.

WARNING: IF YOU ARE NOT COMFORTABLE WITH SOLDERING, OR PERFORMING ANY STEP IN THIS GUIDE, DO NOT PERFORM THE INSTALL YOURSELF. FIND SOMEONE WHO IS COMFORTABLE TO DO IT FOR YOU.

INDEX

DESCRIPTION 4
FEATURES 4
INCLUDED 4
RECOMMENDED / REQUIRED [NOT INCLUDED] 5
NOTES 5
BOARD DETAILS 6
INSTALLATION STEPS 7
PRE INSTALLATION STEPS 8
1. DISASSEMBLY THE CARD SHELL 8
2. DISASSEMBLY THE CIRCUIT COMPONENTS 10
INSTALLATION STEPS 12
1. ISOLATION OF THE CIRCUIT 12
2. SANDING THE CENTERING TABS [OPTIONAL] 13
3. SOLDERING TUTORIALS 14
4. SOLDERING SMALL COMPONENTS 14
5. SOLDERING THE FOUR CHIPS 19
6. SOLDERING THE BATTERY HOLDER 23
7. CLEAN THE CIRCUIT 24
8. DONE! 25
FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS - FAQ 27

DESCRIPTION

This is a **full-color printed custom motherboard** for the game **Pokémon Pinball** for Game Boy.

You can use it to customize your original cartridge, whose battery has long since died or whose original PCB has become damaged or corroded.

Additionally, as you can see in the photos, this new circuit will give your Pokémon cartridge an incredible new look. Pair it with a transparent Game Boy or Game Boy Color shell to show off the artwork.

FEATURES

- New full-color printed motherboard for Pokémon Red, Blue and Yellow.
- Replace the battery without soldering whenever it needs replacing.
- Includes a brand-new vibration motor, so there's no need to reuse the original one.
- Compatible with GBFlash, allowing you to back up your save before the transplant and restore it afterwards.

INCLUDED

- 1x Full-color printed custom motherboard.
- 2x 15Ω 0603 resistors (1 required).
- 2x 1K 0603 resistors (1 required).
- 2x 10K 0603 resistors (1 required).
- 5x 10nF 0603 capacitors (4 required).
- 1x SOT-23 NPN transistor.
- 1x SOD-123 Schottky diode.
- 1x Vibration motor.
- 1x Battery holder.
- 1x Custom vinyl sticker for the back with a Pokémon-style design.

RECOMMENDED / REQUIRED [NOT INCLUDED]

- An original Pokémon Red, Blue or Yellow donor cartridge matching the selected version.
- Transparent game cartridge for Game Boy or Game Boy Color. (1)
- New CR2032 button battery.
- 3.8mm gamebit screwdriver.
- Sandpaper or metal files (2)
- Tweezers.
- Tin soldering iron.
- Tin.
- Flux.
- Isopropyl alcohol.

(1) Remember to purchase the shell for the motherboard. You can use either a Game Boy or Game Boy Color shell, as both are fully compatible. **However, the Game Boy Color shell is recommended because it provides more room for the vibration motor.**

(2) Could be optional. In case it's necessary, it serves to reduce the side tabs that the circuit has. This depends on how faithful the shell is to the original; the tabs prevent the circuit from wobbling or shifting from side to side. If the circuit doesn't fit into the shell, you'll need to file the tabs slightly.

NOTES

The board is compatible with two different ROM chip sizes. The photos show the **MX23C1603-12A** ROM, with 44 pins in total, 22 on each side. It is also compatible with the **MX23C8006-12** ROM, with 32 pins in total, 16 on each side

BOARD DETAILS

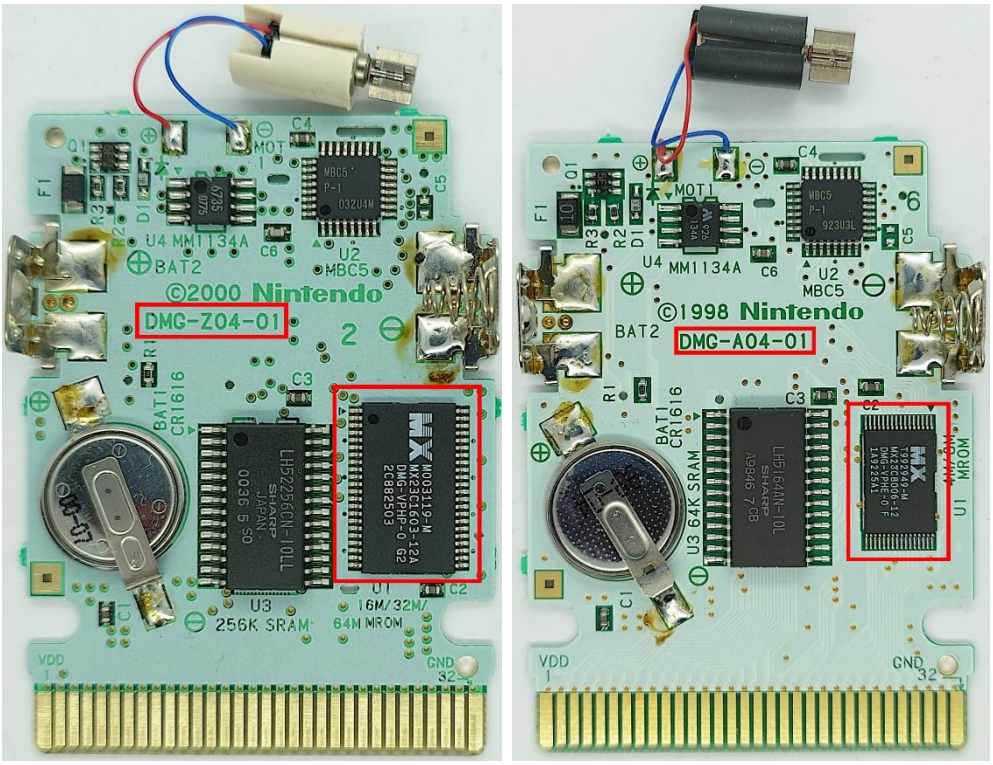
The board doesn't have any connectors or pads where wires need to be soldered like our other kits. However, this board doesn't come assembled; you will be the one to assemble the components supplied with the kit, as well as the 4 chips that make up the game, which you'll need to extract from your donor game.



INSTALLATION STEPS

Please, carefully read the following steps for a successful installation.

There are different versions of the Pokémon Pinball board. The difference between them is the physical size of the ROM chip. The European version uses the 44-pin **MX23C1603-12A** chip. The American and Japanese versions use the 32-pin **MX23C8006-12** chip.



Circuit images from https://gbhwdb.gekkio.fi

NOTE: *The board should also be compatible with any other Game Boy game that uses a **DMG-Z04-01** or **DMG-A04-01** motherboard.*

So, even though the board design has nothing to do with the original game's design, it will allow you to restore it using a shell in whatever color you want.

PRE INSTALLATION STEPS

Before proceeding with the installation, **you need to retrieve the 4 chips that make up Pokémon game from your game circuit**. These chips must be transplanted to the new circuit.

This is where all the difficulty of the installation lies, as it is most convenient to use a hot air soldering station or a heating table to extract the chips. It is not recommended to use just a soldering iron, although perhaps in combination with a desoldering pump, it may be possible. The choice of tools is up to you.

1. DISASSEMBLY THE CARD SHELL

First, you'll need to open the original game cartridge.

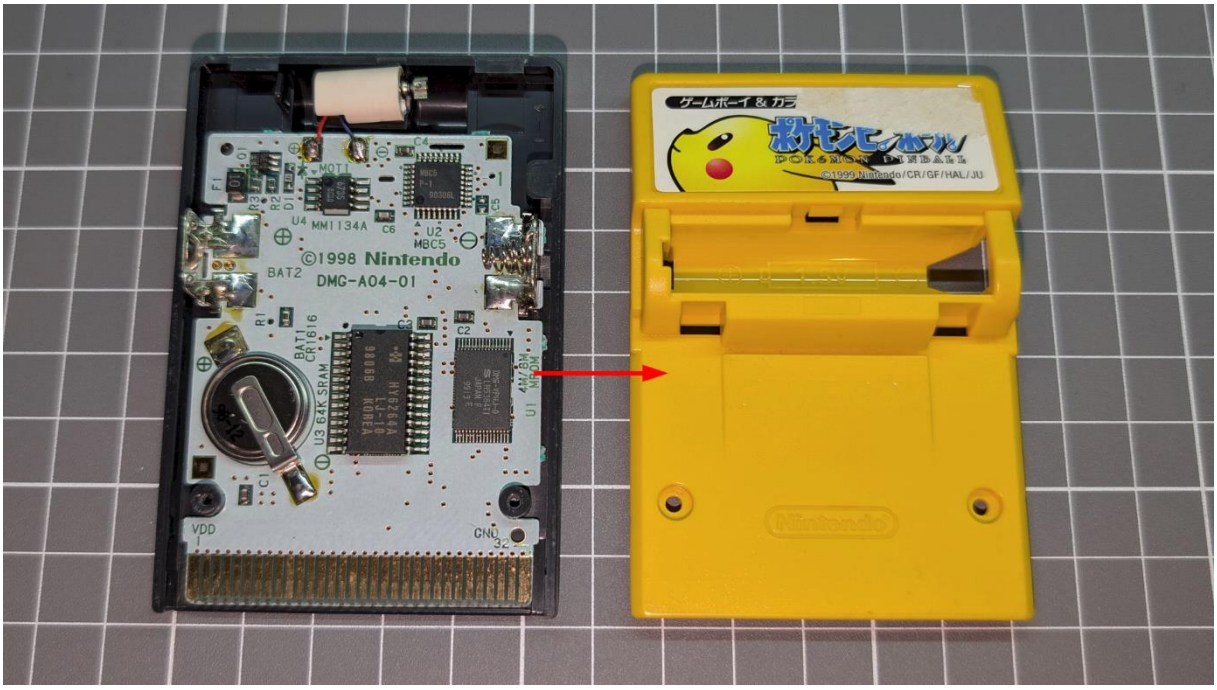


Gamebit screwdriver

The cartridge uses a **3.8mm gamebit screw**, this is the screw:



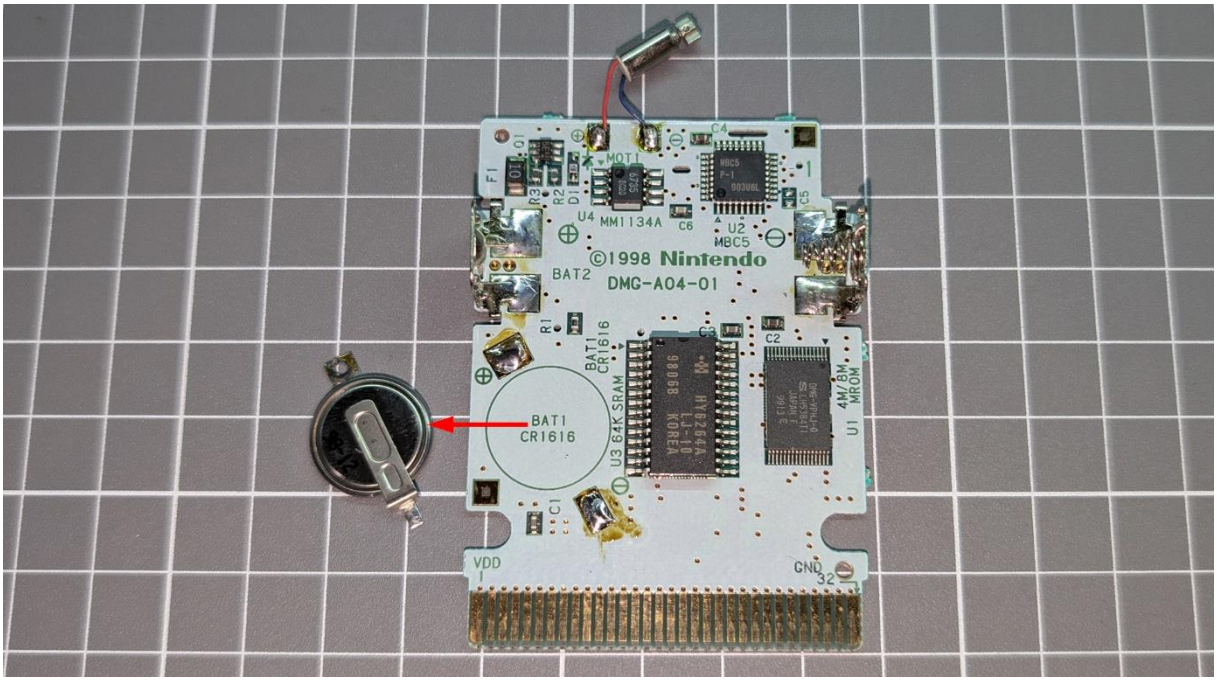
Once opened, you'll see the interior, just an electrical circuit where all the components are soldered.



2. DISASSEMBLY THE CIRCUIT COMPONENTS

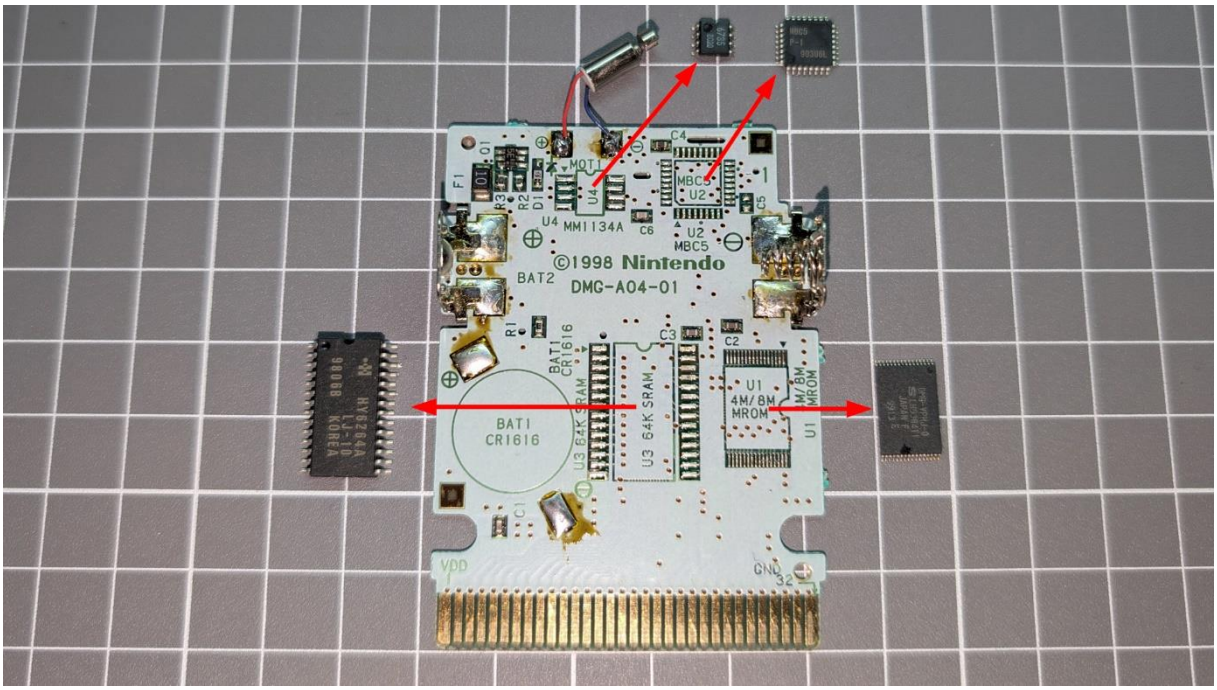
The first component to **remove is the game's battery**. No matter what type of tools you'll use to remove the rest of the components, **this component must be removed manually with a soldering iron.**

Optionally, you can use a heating plate. However, **if you use a hot air gun, do not apply hot air directly to the battery for safety reasons**. Instead, you can heat the board from underneath until it is warm enough to remove the battery with tweezers.



IMPORTANT NOTE: Removing the battery will erase any saved game data (if it hasn't already happened due to the battery running out). It is recommended to make a backup first if you don't want to lose your game progress.

Then comes the tricky part. It is recommended to use a hot plate or a hot air soldering station, in both cases heating the circuit from the underside so that the chips do not receive excessive heat. You can add a bit of flux to help the solder melt more quickly and thus free the chip to be removed with tweezers.



You don't need to remove any other components, as new ones are included in the kit.

INSTALLATION STEPS

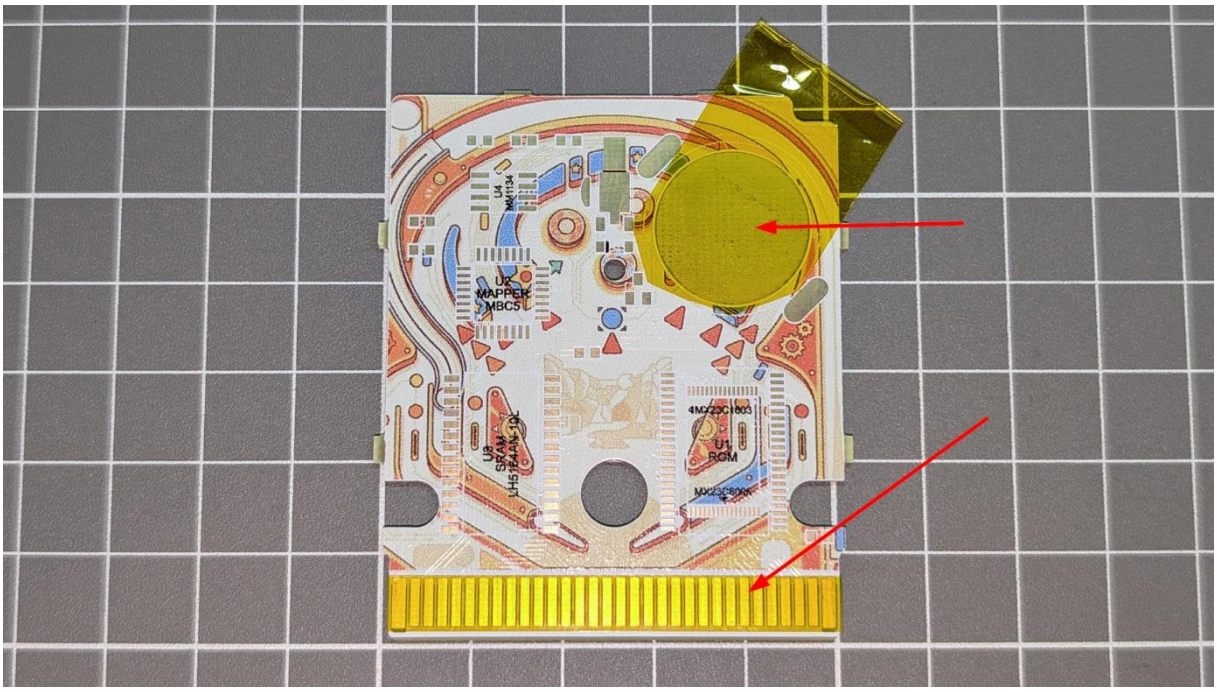
1. ISOLATION OF THE CIRCUIT

As you can see when opening the kit bag, the circuit already includes a kapton tape that protects the bottom where the pads are located, which will make electrical connection with the Game Boy game connector.

The negative terminal of the battery is also protected. Do not remove this until after soldering the battery holder.

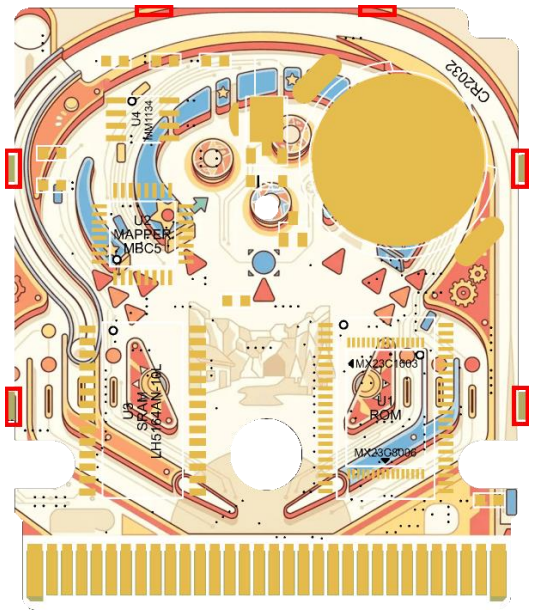
It's crucial to keep this kapton tape in place until you finish the installation completely. This prevents accidental solder from falling onto these pads and ruining the PCB.

If you have removed the kapton tape, put it back in place 😊



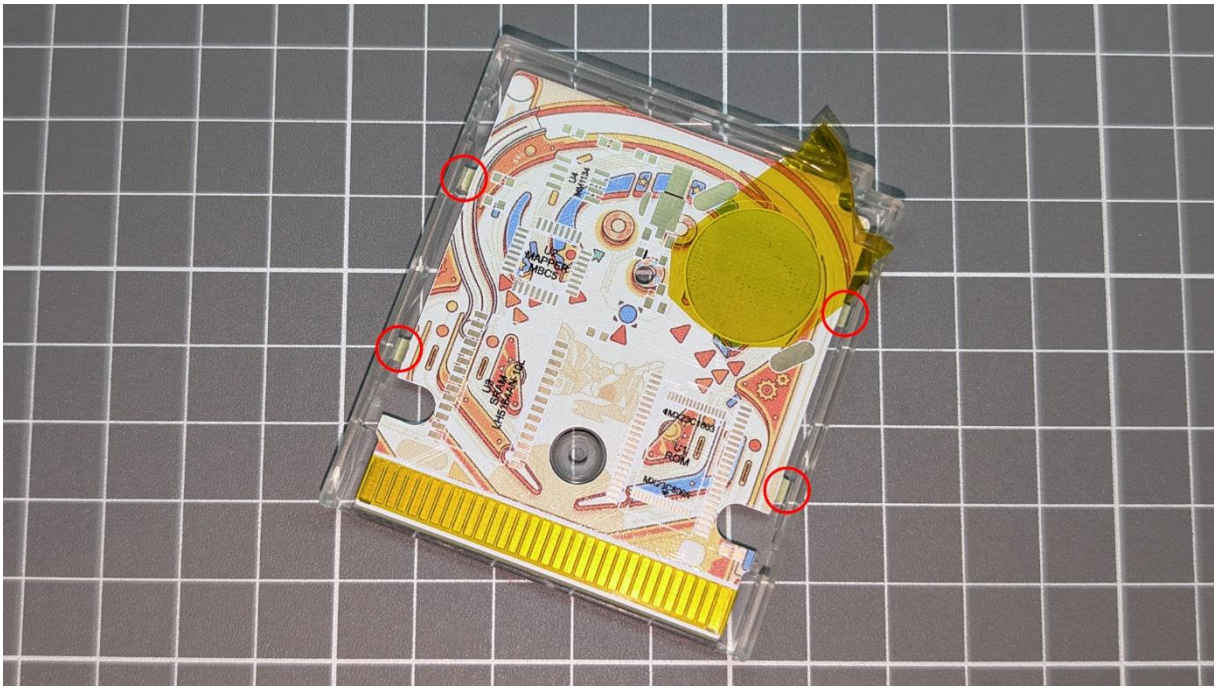
2. SANDING THE CENTERING TABS [OPTIONAL]

Since there's a wide variety of manufacturers producing card shells for Game Boy, not all of them have the same dimensions as the original shells. That's why the included circuit has side and top tabs to try to centre the circuit as much as possible within the shell.



Insert the circuit into the shell you want to use and check if it fits correctly. If you have trouble inserting it, you'll need to sand the tabs very slightly, first on one side and then on the other. Sand gradually and check if the circuit fits into place or not.

When you finish, clean the circuit with isopropyl alcohol.



3. SOLDERING TUTORIALS

We especially like these two videos, although there are countless of them on the internet:

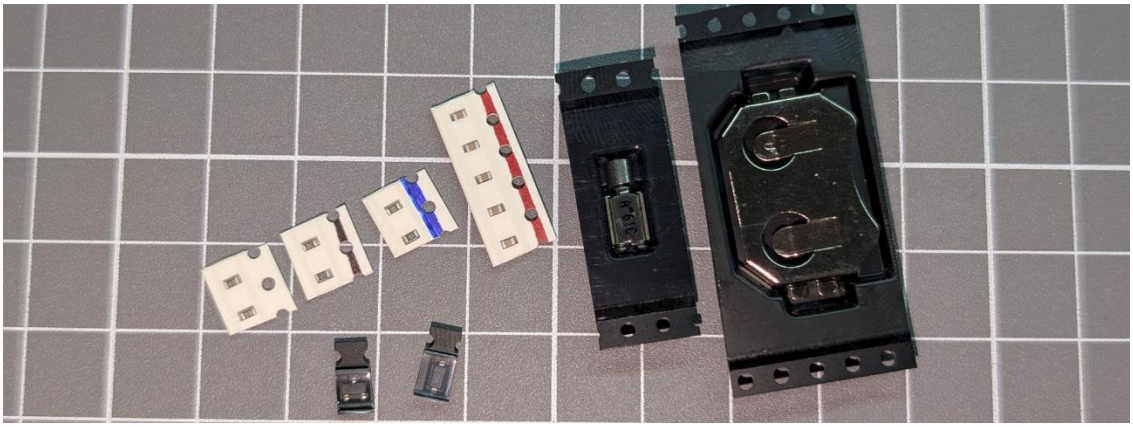
- SMD Soldering
- Professional SMT Soldering

4. SOLDERING SMALL COMPONENTS

It's time to proceed with the installation of everything. Start with the smallest components first, then the 4 chips in a specific order, and finally the battery holder.

The kit includes more resistors and capacitors than necessary because some might get lost during installation. Make sure to remove the components from the protective film one by one as needed and be careful not to lose them.

The **resistors are black** and have numbers written on them. The capacitors are brown.

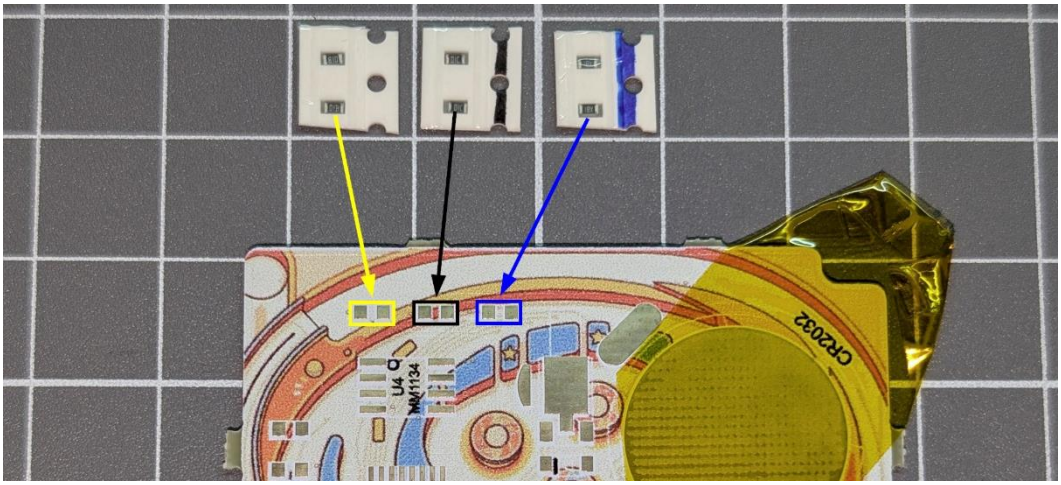


The circuit requires:

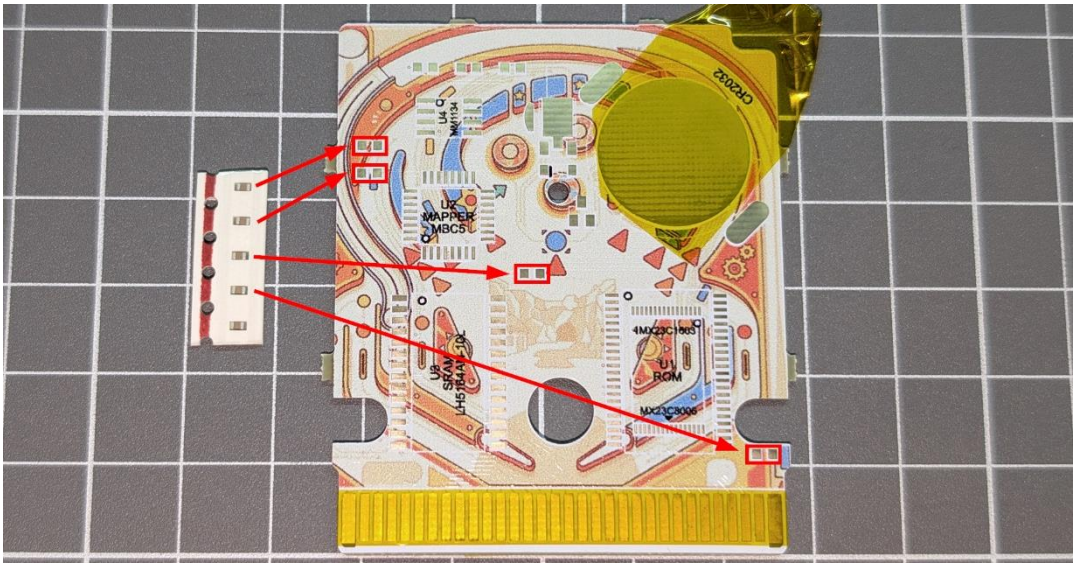
- 1x 1K resistor sized 0603.
- 1x 10K resistor sized 0603.
- 1x 15Ω resistor sized 0603.
- 4x 10nF 0603 capacitors.
- 1x SOT-23 NPN transistor.
- 1x SOD-123 Schottky diode.
- 1x Vibration motor.
- 1x Battery holder.

The tape/cardboard packaging of each resistor is marked with a permanent marker to help you easily identify each component.

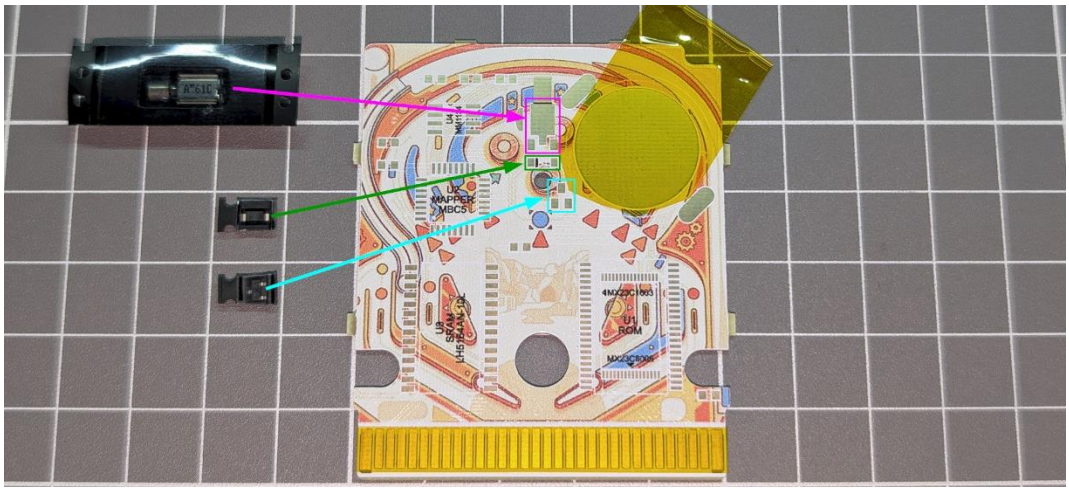
This is where you should solder the 1K resistor (no color), the 10K resistor, and the 15Ω resistor.



Here you should solder the 10nF capacitors.

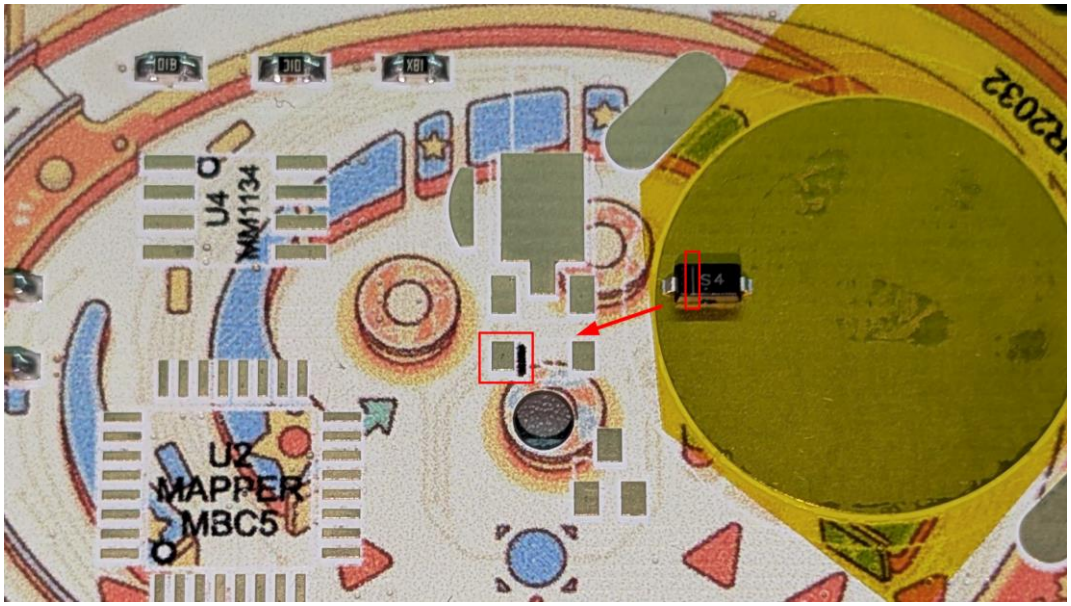


Finally, solder the vibrator, the diode in the correct polarity, and the transistor here.

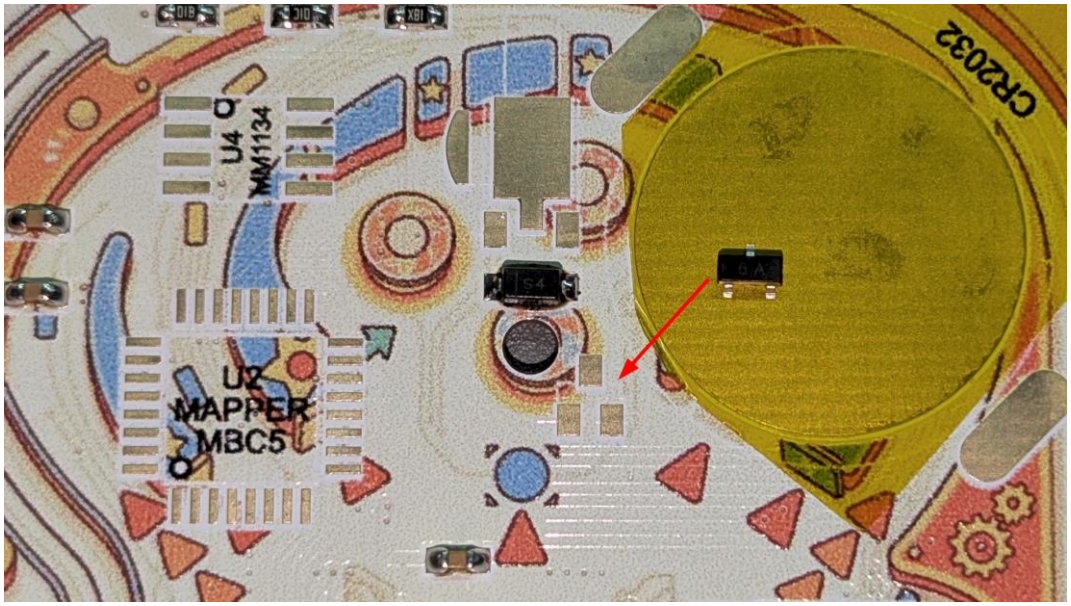


When soldering these last three components, keep the following in mind:

1) Diode: It has polarity. You will notice a white stripe on the component, which must face left. If you look closely, the circuit also has a stripe to indicate the correct position.



2) Transistor: It has three pins and does not require any special attention. Just solder it in place.



3) Vibrator: This component is more difficult to solder.

If you have a hot air soldering station or a heating plate, simply apply a little solder to the three pads, place the vibration motor in position, and heat the PCB. The motor will automatically align itself and be soldered in place.

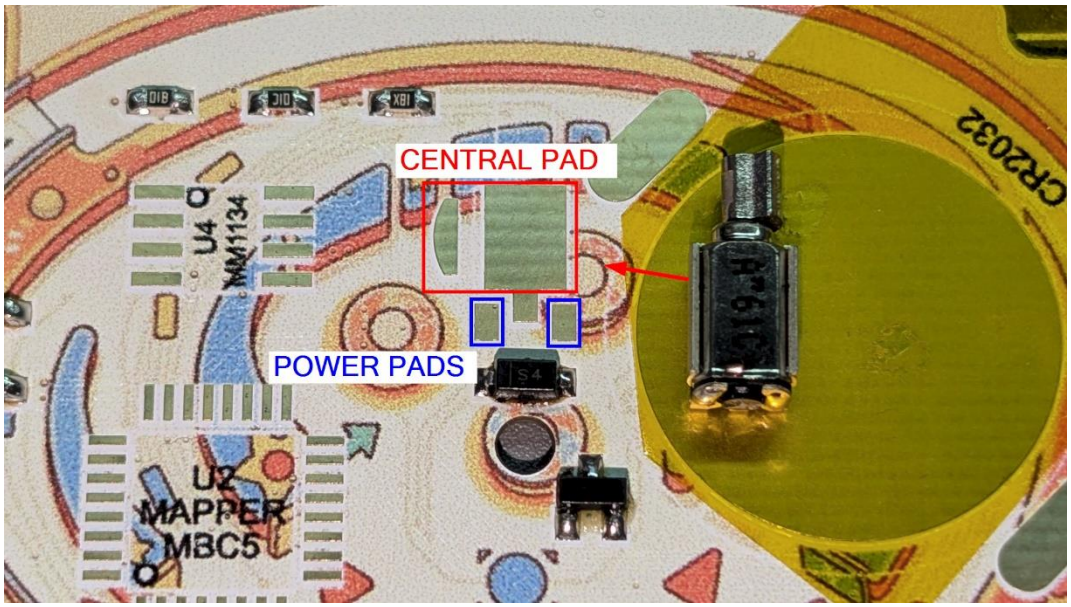
If you only have a soldering iron, you will notice that the PCB has a fourth pad on the left side. The idea is as follows:

First, pre-tin all four pads, but remove the solder from the two lower pads (the power pads) using solder wick, leaving as little solder as possible.

Then, place the motor in position and heat the left pad with your soldering iron. This should also heat the central pad and allow the motor to be soldered in place.

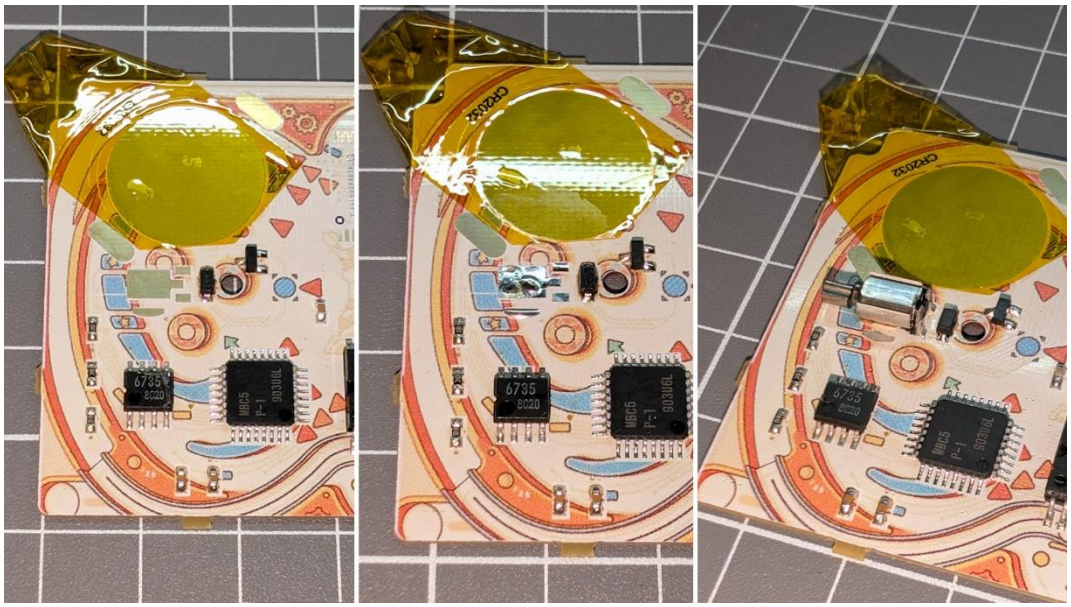
Finally, solder the two lower power pads. If you want, you can remove all the solder from the left pad, as it has no other purpose.

Be careful not to apply too much solder to the central pad. Otherwise, the motor may not be able to spin if you use an original Game Boy cartridge shell. If you use a Game Boy Color cartridge shell, this should not be a problem.



In my case, since I will clean the PCB using an ultrasonic cleaner and an alcohol bath (optional), I will solder the vibration motor at the very end to avoid getting it wet. However, this makes soldering even more difficult because all the other components will already be installed.

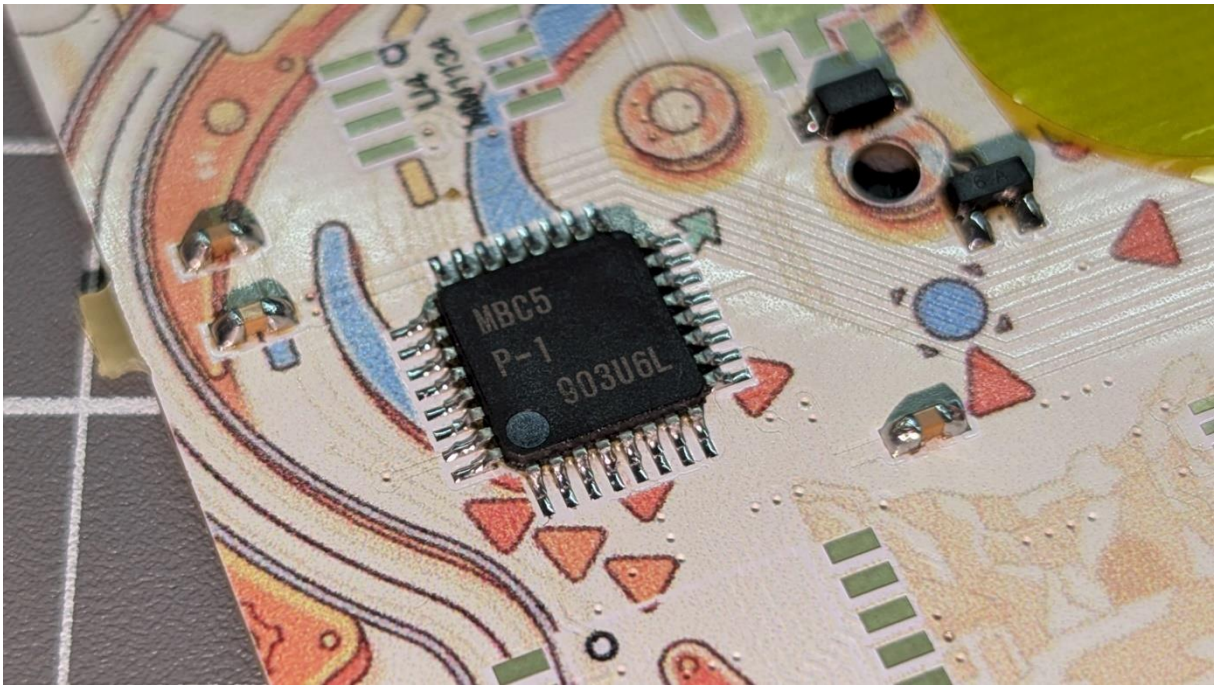
So, to summarize: pre-tin all the pads, remove the excess solder from the power pads, heat the left pad, and place the motor in position to solder it. Finally, solder the power pads and clean the left pad.



5. SOLDERING THE FOUR CHIPS

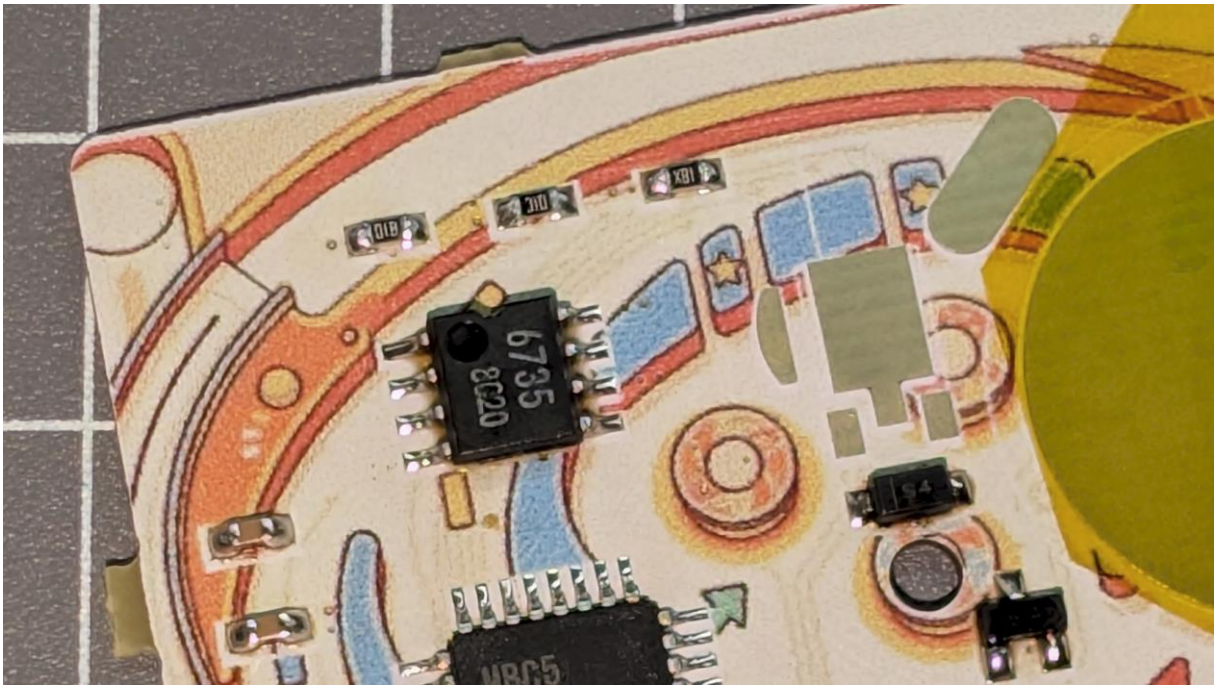
Start by soldering the four chips. In principle, the order doesn't matter, as they don't interfere with each other and there is enough space between them for soldering. However, it might be easier to start with the U2 MAPPER, as it has pins on all four sides.

IMPORTANT NOTE: When soldering each chip, make sure you do it in the correct position. You'll see that both the chip and the soldering site are marked with a circle indicating pin number one.

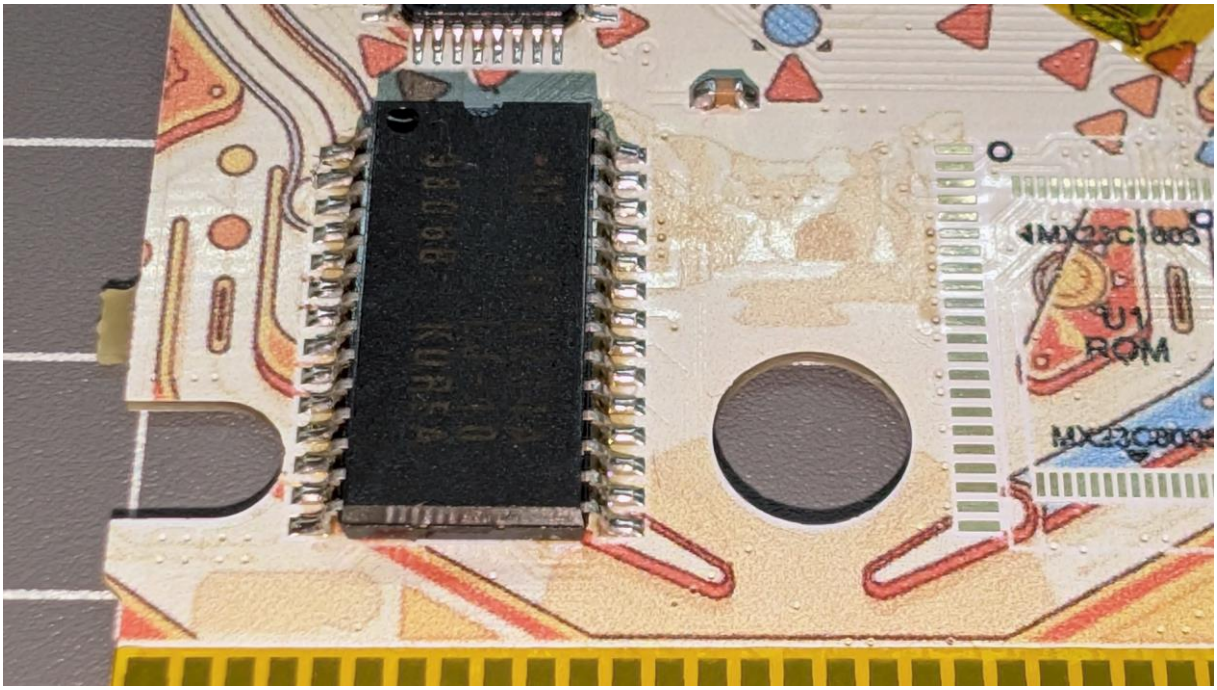


U2 MAPPER

Continue soldering the remaining chips in whichever order you prefer.



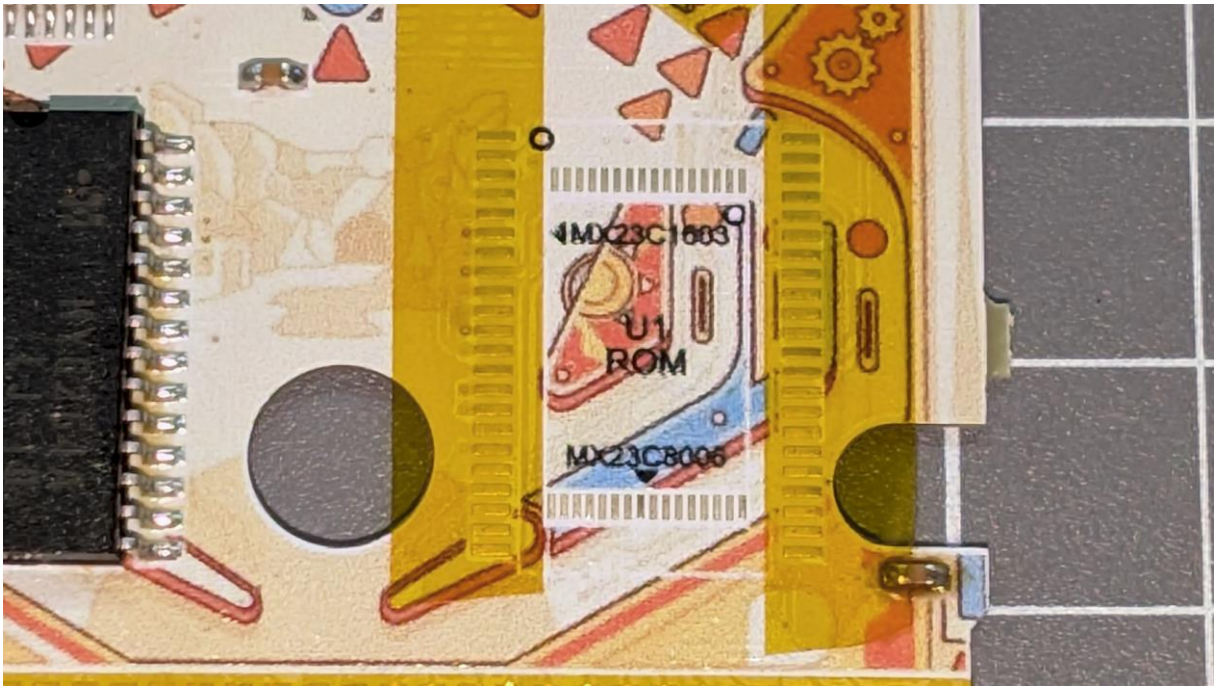
U4 SRAM-SUPERVISOR

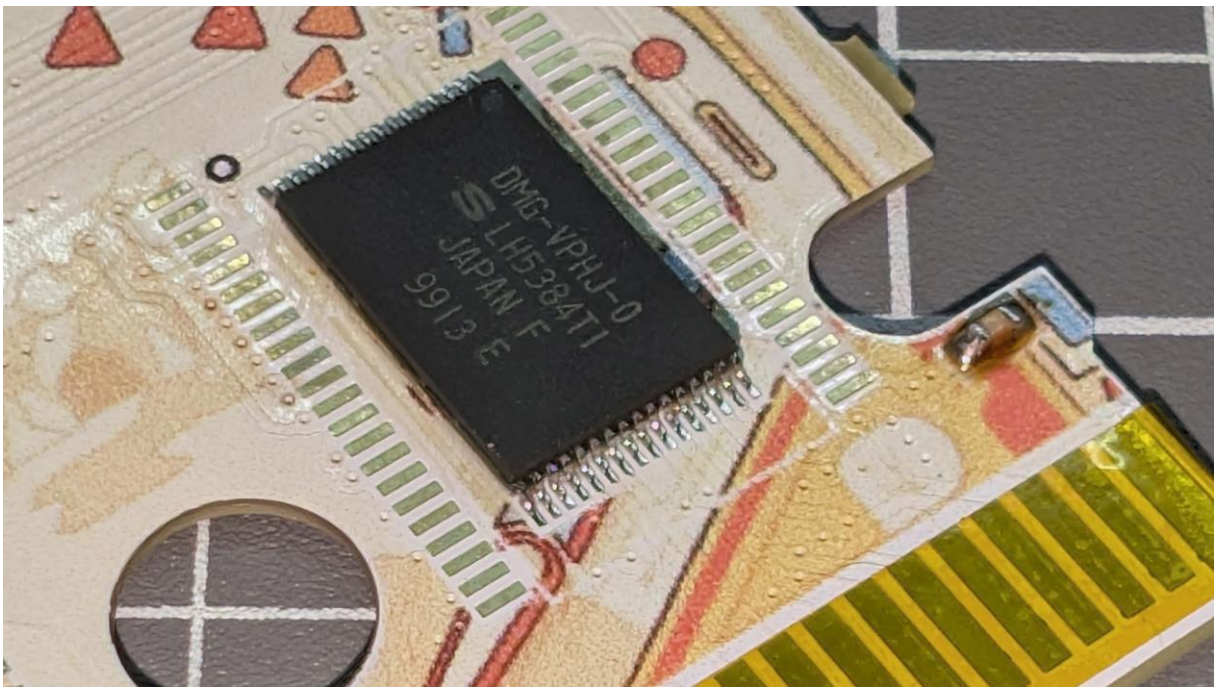


U3 SRAM

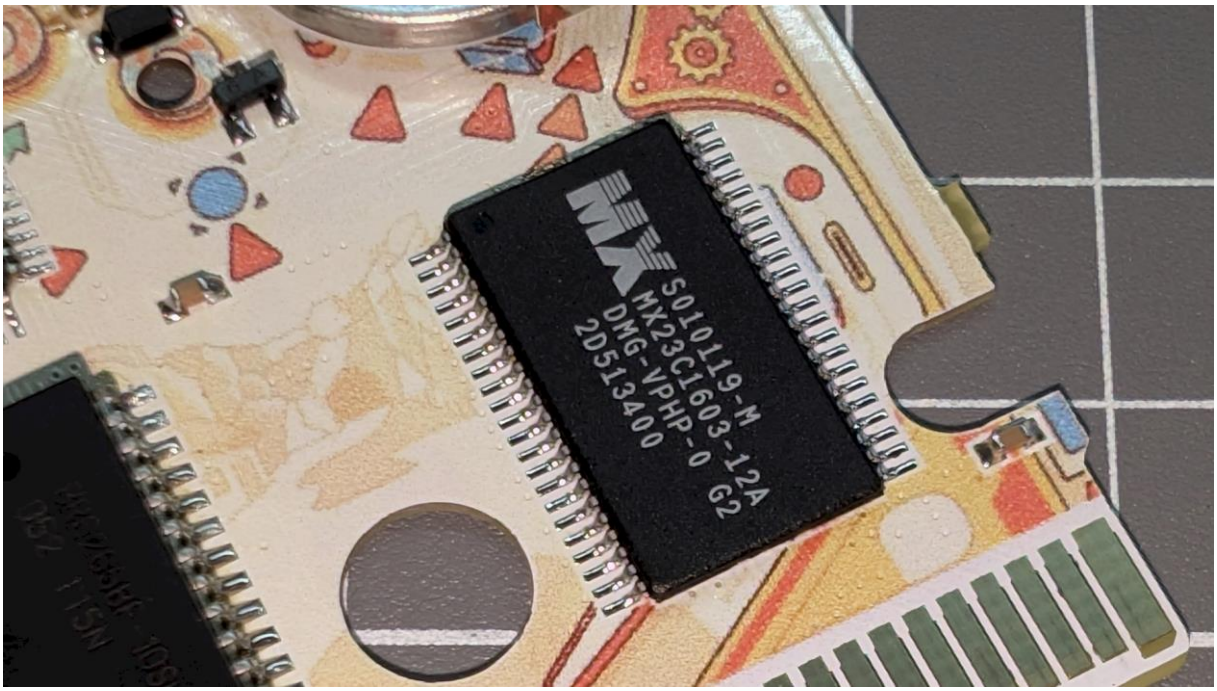
Regarding the ROM chip, there are two versions: the European version, which has a larger chip with pins on the left and right sides, and the Japanese/American version, which has a smaller chip with pins on the top and bottom.

The PCB is compatible with both chip sizes. Just cover the pads you are not going to use with Kapton tape to prevent solder from getting onto them.





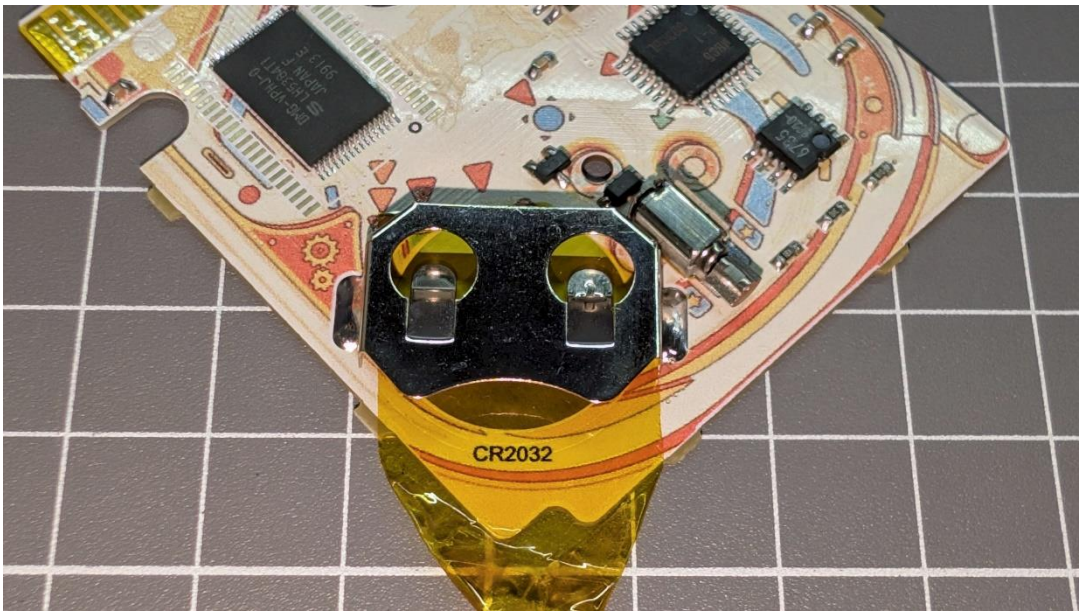
U1 ROM component for American and Japanese versions



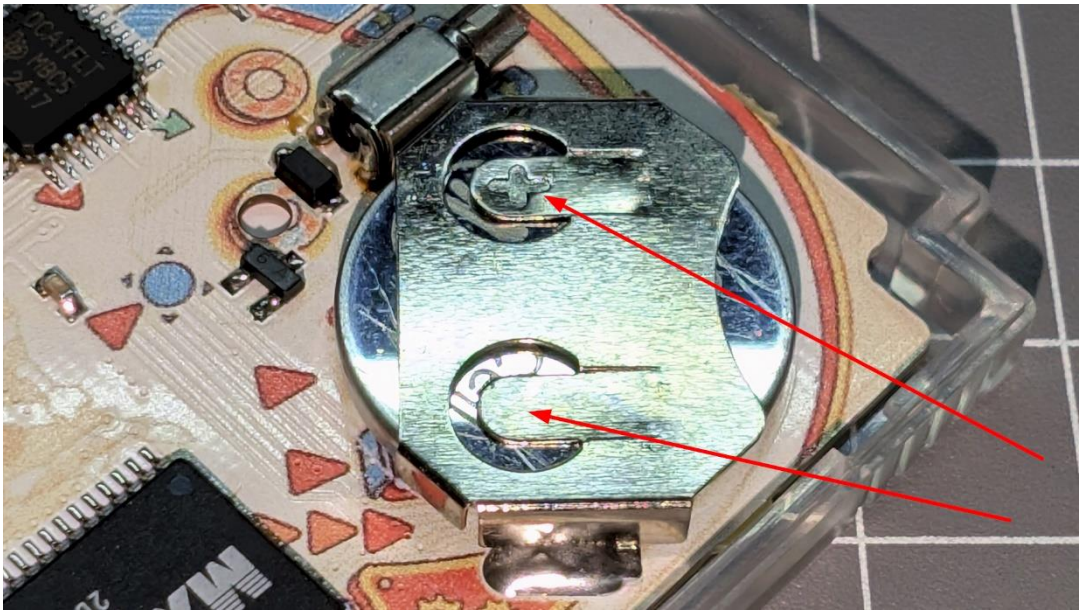
U1 ROM component for European version

6. SOLDERING THE BATTERY HOLDER

Solder the metal piece that will hold the battery in place. You must centre it properly, otherwise, the cartridge shell may not close afterward. If you prefer, you can solder one side first and check that it closes properly, then solder the other side to complete the installation.

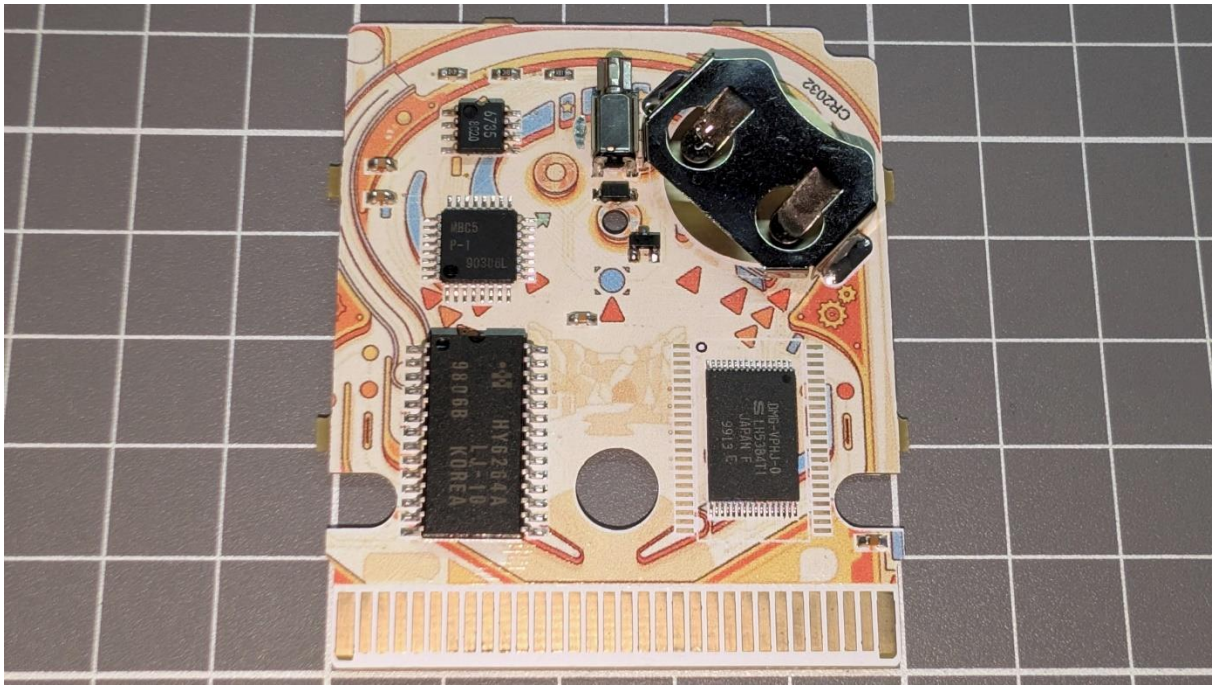


Once you have soldered both sides of the battery holder. Insert the battery into the battery holder. When you do this, you'll notice that the top tabs protrude too much. This prevents the cartridge shell from closing and may scratch it! You'll need to press them down slightly to make them flatter, you can use a flathead screwdriver to apply force and flatten the tabs.



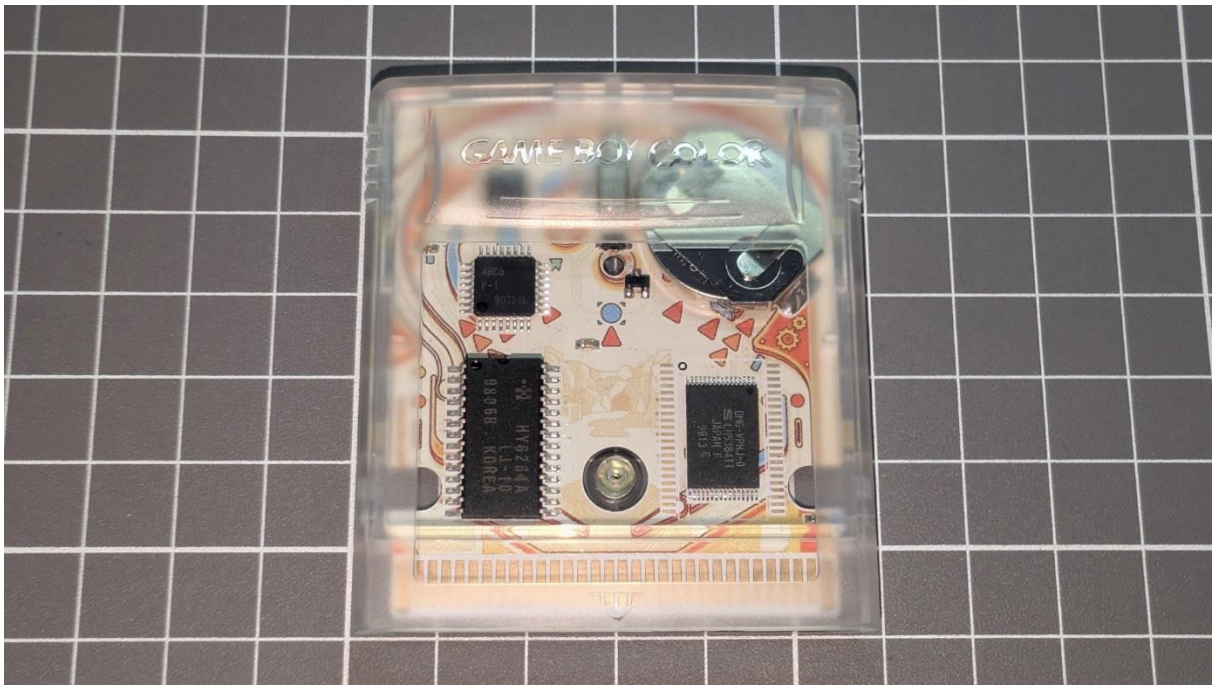
7. CLEAN THE CIRCUIT

The installation is complete. If you haven't done so during the installation of each component, it's time to clean the circuit with isopropyl alcohol.



8. DONE!

We now have our Pokémon game with its new colorful circuit, new battery, and transparent shell, making it look truly amazing!






GAME BOY COLOR

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS - FAQ

1. ***THE GAME DOESN'T WORK OR DOESN'T FUNCTION CORRECTLY.***

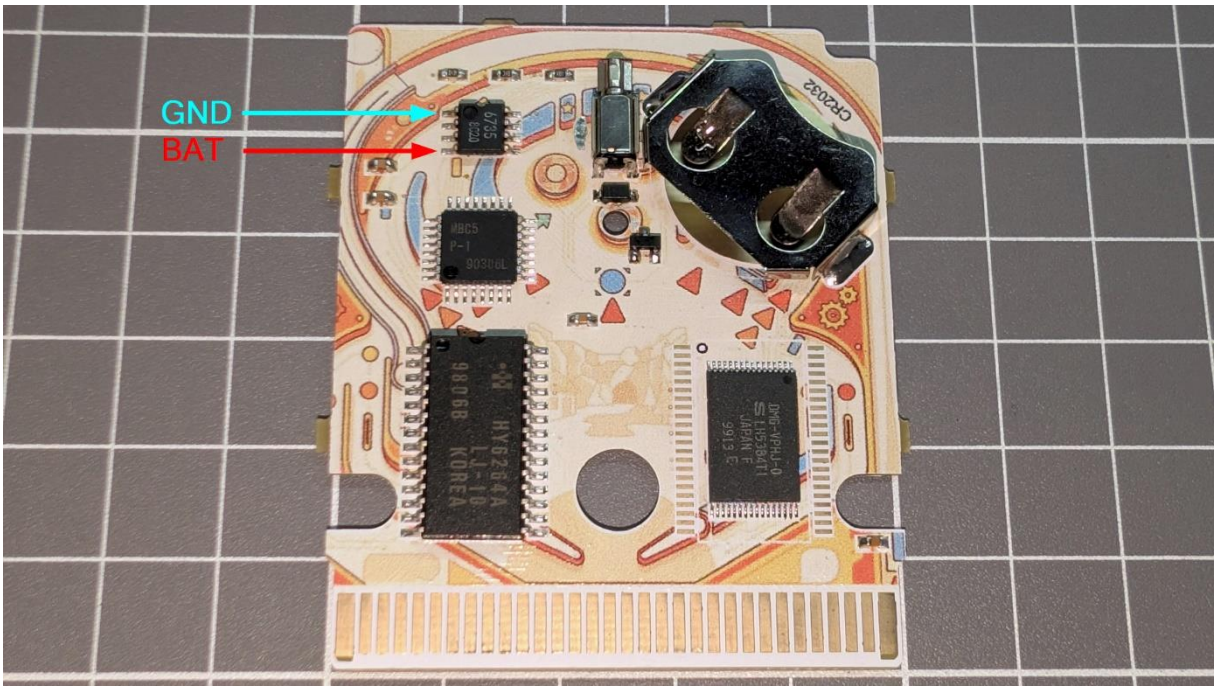
   Ensure that all chip connections to the circuit are properly made, that there are no cold solder joints, and that there are no short circuits between pins, etc.

   Use the following diagram to help you verify that each connection is correctly made. (*It's on the last page of the guide*)

2. ***THE GAME DOESN'T SAVE PROGRESS, AND WHEN YOU TURN ON THE CONSOLE, THE SAVED GAME IS LOST.***

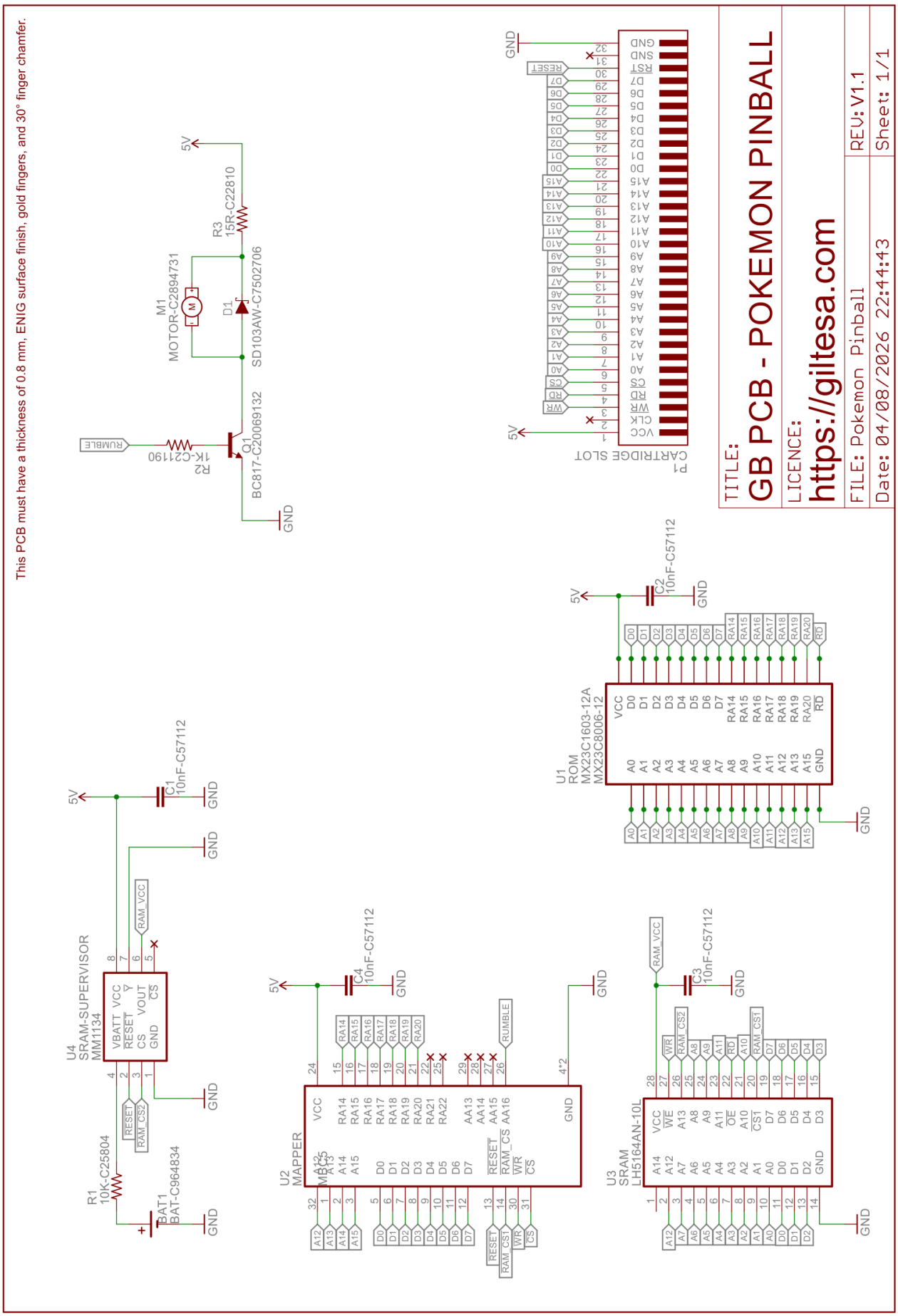
   Ensure that the battery is not depleted, is inserted correctly (positive side up), and that the current is properly reaching the circuit.

   You can measure the voltage at these points with your multimeter to verify that the current is reaching the circuit:



3. THE VIBRATION MOTOR IS NOT WORKING

If you are using a Game Boy cartridge shell, make sure the motor is not touching the top cover. If it is, you can easily fix this by placing something between the motor and the plastic to create some space, such as a small piece of double-sided tape or a drop of glue. Make sure the glue has dried completely before putting the PCB back into the cartridge shell.


This PCB must have a thickness of 0.8 mm, ENIG surface finish, gold fingers, and 30° finger chamfer.
TITLE:
GB PCB - POKEMON PINBALL
LICENCE:
https://giltesa.com
FILE: Pokemon Pinball
REV: V1.1
Date: 04/08/2026 22:44:43
Sheet: 1/1
CARTRIDGE SLOT
P1
M1
MOTOR-C2894731
D1
SD103AW-C7502706
R3
15R-C22810
Q1
BC817-C20069132
R2
1K-C21190
RUMBLE
U1
ROM
MX23C1603-12A
MX23C8006-12
U2
MAPPER
U3
SRAM
LH5164AN-10L
U4
SRAM-SUPERVISOR
MM1134
R1
10K-C25804
BAT1
BAT-C964834
C1
10nF-C57112
C2
10nF-C57112
C3
10nF-C57112
C4
10nF-C57112
5V
GND
RAM_VCC
RESET
RAM_CS2
RAM_CS1
RUMBLE